

Policy on Information and Education about Healthcare Needs

«Hospital Name»

Document control

Document No.	HCO/PRE/POL/05	Version	2.0
Issue No.	01	Review due	One year from implementation
Date created	_____	Date of implementation	_____
Prepared by	Nursing Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Reviewed by	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved by	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

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Statement of intent

Patients and families at «Hospital Name» have a right to information and education about their healthcare needs, delivered in a way they can understand and act on.

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how «Hospital Name» educates patients and families — in a language and format they understand, on medication safety, food-drug interaction, diet and nutrition, immunisation, pain management, their specific disease process, and preventing healthcare-associated infections — and how special educational needs and patient engagement are addressed.

This policy does not cover informed consent, patient rights generally, or information on costs — those are covered in other hospital policies.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all patients and families receiving care at «Hospital Name», across out-patient and in-patient settings.

3. Policy standards

«Hospital Name» educates patients and families in a language and format they can understand; about the safe and effective use of medication and its potential side effects when appropriate; about food-drug interaction; about diet and nutrition; about immunisations; on pain

management techniques when appropriate; about their specific disease process, complications and prevention strategies; and about preventing healthcare-associated infections.

«Hospital Name» identifies and addresses patients' and families' special educational needs, and has a mechanism to promote patient engagement to enhance clinical outcomes, safety and quality.

4. Non-negotiable rules

- Do not educate a patient or family in a language or format they cannot understand — screen for understanding and language needs first.
- Educate every patient or family on the safe and effective use of their medication and its potential side effects, where appropriate.
- Educate every patient or family about food-drug interactions for all drugs on the hospital's identified list.
- Do not give diet and nutrition education that omits general recommendations for a healthy diet.
- Deliver immunisation education to families of all paediatric patients in line with the universal immunisation programme.
- Do not deliver pain-management education outside the patient's personal, cultural and religious beliefs.
- Do not give disease-specific education that omits lifestyle modifications, diet changes or immunisation where appropriate.
- Educate every patient or family on how to prevent healthcare-associated infections.
- Do not identify a special educational need without addressing it.
- Staff who see a rule under this policy broken report it the same shift to the Nursing Superintendent or the Medical Superintendent.

5. What we do

5.1 Education in an understood language and format

During treatment, patients and/or families at «Hospital Name» are screened — at least informally — for their understanding abilities and language requirements. Education is delivered through counselling, printed material or audio-visual aids in the language and format identified from that screening.

5.2 Medication safety education

«Hospital Name» maintains a list of drugs for which education on safe and effective use and potential side effects is required — for example digoxin — and educates patients and/or families against that list when those drugs are prescribed or dispensed, including the importance of taking a drug at a specific time where relevant.

5.3 Food-drug interaction education

«Hospital Name» maintains a list of drugs, or drug classes, for which food-drug interactions are clinically relevant — for example no alcohol when taking metronidazole — and educates patients and families about their diet during medication when a drug on that list is prescribed.

5.4 Diet and nutrition education

Education on diet and nutrition at «Hospital Name» incorporates general recommendations for following a healthy diet, and may also cover the relationship between specific foods or supplements and particular health conditions.

5.5 Immunisation education

Paediatric immunisation education at «Hospital Name» follows the universal immunisation programme. Adult patients are educated on relevant vaccines — for example influenza, pneumococcal, typhoid, hepatitis B, or meningococcal vaccines — as determined by the treating doctor based on the patient's condition and risk profile.

5.6 Pain management education

Where appropriate — typically for patients likely to have long-term pain because the underlying condition is not treatable — «Hospital Name» educates the patient and/or family on pain management techniques, within the framework of their personal, cultural and religious beliefs.

5.7 Disease-specific education

Education on a patient's specific disease process, complications and prevention strategies at «Hospital Name» includes lifestyle modifications — stress management, physical exercise, cessation of smoking and substance abuse — and covers diet changes and immunisations where appropriate to the condition. This may be delivered through booklets, videos or leaflets.

5.8 Healthcare-associated infection prevention education

«Hospital Name» educates patients and families about preventing healthcare-associated infections — for example hand washing and avoiding overcrowding near the patient.

5.9 Special educational needs

Special educational needs of patients and/or family members — for example related to ADHD, autism support, physical disabilities, speech and communication needs, or social and emotional health needs — are identified during treatment and addressed through counselling, printed material, audio-visual aids or other adapted means.

5.10 Patient engagement

«Hospital Name» works to create an enabling environment for partnership between patients, families, communities and healthcare providers, and encourages patients to become actively involved in reporting safety incidents, near misses and safety concerns. This may include disease-based patient support groups, a patient advisory council, and designated patient safety champions or advocates, where appropriate.

6. Stop-work authority

Not applicable. This standard has no stop-work authority — gaps in patient and family education are addressed through the hospital's quality monitoring and CAPA process (Section 8), not through an immediate stop-work trigger.

7. Governance and responsibility

Role	Responsibility
Medical Superintendent	Accountable for ensuring patients and families receive education as required by this policy; receives escalations under Section 4.
Nursing Superintendent	Owns implementation of this policy; coordinates patient and family education across departments; holds education records.
Pharmacy In-Charge	Maintains the medication-safety and food-drug interaction education lists; keeps these current with the formulary.
Treating Doctor / Care Team	Delivers or assigns disease-specific, pain-management and immunisation education relevant to the individual patient.
Quality Coordinator	Audits this policy; holds training records and staff acknowledgements.

8. Quality monitoring

Monitoring area	What is monitored
Language and format	Evidence of language/format screening; education given in the identified language and format.
Medication safety	Written drug-education list; counselling records for patients receiving listed drugs.
Food-drug interaction	Written food-drug interaction list; counselling or diet-note records.
Diet and nutrition	In-patient diet education records; out-patient diet counselling records.
Immunisation	Adult immunisation advice records; paediatric immunisation counselling records referencing the universal immunisation programme.
Pain management	Long-term pain education records for identified patients.
Disease-specific education	Education records covering disease process, lifestyle, diet and immunisation.
HAI prevention	Admission-checklist education records confirming person-to-person education.
Special educational needs	Identified-need records; corresponding adapted-education or counselling records.
Patient engagement	Engagement activity records — support

	groups, advisory council, safety champion appointments, patient safety incident reports received.
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This policy shall be reviewed at least once every year, or earlier if NABH standards change.

9. Training and staff acknowledgement

All staff covered by this policy are trained on the education requirements described in Section 5 at induction and periodically.

I have read the Policy on Information and Education about Healthcare Needs of «Hospital Name» and understand my responsibilities under it.

Staff name	Designation	Signature	Date
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

10. Distribution

This policy shall be available to the Nursing department, Pharmacy, all clinical department heads, and all staff through the hospital intranet and department policy folders.

11. Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
ADHD	Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder
CAPA	Corrective and Preventive Action
HAI	Healthcare-Associated Infection
NABH	National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers
OPD	Out-Patient Department

12. Traceability table

This table is an index. It is not how the policy is organised. An asterisk in the Level column means the objective element is starred and requires documented evidence.

Objective Element	Level	Traceability to this policy
PRE.5.a	CORE	Sections 3 and 5.1 address education in a language and format the patient and/or family can understand, including informal screening for language needs.
PRE.5.b	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.2 address education on safe and effective medication use and

		potential side effects, using the hospital's drug-education list.
PRE.5.c	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.3 address education on food-drug interactions, using the hospital's food-drug interaction list.
PRE.5.d	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.4 address diet and nutrition education, including general healthy-diet recommendations.
PRE.5.e	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.5 address immunisation education, following the universal immunisation programme for paediatric patients.
PRE.5.f	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.6 address pain-management education for patients likely to have long-term pain, within personal, cultural and religious beliefs.
PRE.5.g	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.7 address disease-specific education, including lifestyle modifications, diet changes and immunisation where appropriate.
PRE.5.h	Commitment	Sections 3 and 5.8 address education on preventing healthcare-associated infections, including hand washing and avoiding overcrowding.
PRE.5.i	Achievement	Sections 3 and 5.9 address identification and addressing of patients' and families' special educational needs.
PRE.5.j	Excellence	Sections 3 and 5.10 address mechanisms to promote patient engagement, including support groups, advisory council and safety champions.

13. Required Records/Evidence Checklist

Education language and format — PRE.5.a (CORE)

- Language/format screening record (admission note, nursing kardex or counselling record), education given, and the format used.

Medication safety education — PRE.5.b (Commitment)

- Written drug-education list (current version).
- Counselling records for sampled patients who received a listed drug.

Food-drug interaction education — PRE.5.c (Commitment)

- Written food-drug interaction list.
- Counselling or diet-note records for sampled patients who received a listed drug.

Diet and nutrition education — PRE.5.d (Commitment)

- In-patient diet education records (for patients on therapeutic diets).
- Out-patient diet counselling records when ordered by the treating doctor.

Immunisation education — PRE.5.e (Commitment)

- Records of immunisation advice given to adults, noting vaccines discussed or due.
- Paediatric immunisation counselling records referencing the universal immunisation programme.

Pain management education — PRE.5.f (Commitment)

- Records of long-term pain-management education for identified patients, noting the treating doctor's rationale and the cultural/religious framework respected.

Disease-specific education — PRE.5.g (Commitment)

- Education records for sampled patients, covering disease process, complications, lifestyle modifications, diet and immunisation.
- Supporting materials used (booklets, videos, leaflets).

HAI prevention education — PRE.5.h (Commitment)

- HAI-prevention education records on the admission checklist confirming person-to-person education occurred.

Special educational needs — PRE.5.i (Achievement)

- Identified-need records in the patient chart.
- Corresponding adapted-education or counselling records showing the need was met.

Patient engagement — PRE.5.j (Excellence)

- Engagement activity records — support group sessions, advisory council meetings, safety champion appointments, and patient safety incident reports received from patients or families.

14. References

1. National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers. NABH Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition. PRE.5.

Disclaimer

This document is a template prepared for the guidance of «Hospital Name» and must be reviewed, adapted and formally approved by «Hospital Name» before use. Every entry marked _____ must be completed before the document is issued.

This policy is intended for accreditation and internal governance purposes and is not a statement of, or substitute for, compliance with any specific statute; «Hospital Name» remains separately responsible for meeting all applicable statutory and regulatory requirements.

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